



RIGHTSIZE. RIGHT SUPPORT. **RIGHT** *for* **STUDENTS.**

A family guide to the proposed school changes

Every school is a community. A school change can affect friendships, routines, programs, and a family's sense of belonging. This guide explains what is proposed and why.

Scenarios A and B are proposals, not final decisions. "No changes proposed" means these options do not include a change for that school.

Each school has a snapshot and a box explaining the reasons for the proposal. The next page shows enrollment estimates, programs, student groups, and maps. Estimates cover 2027-28 through 2031-32. They are not current student counts.

The possible benefits are goals. A larger school does not automatically get a full-time librarian, certain staff, or specific programs. Those details depend on the district's staffing rules, budget, and plans for making the changes.

A school or program move does not determine where an individual student receiving special education services will go. Families and school teams would need to plan each student's services and support.

The school details, numbers, and maps come from PPS school profiles. This guide explains that information in simpler language.

Words you may see in this guide

No changes

What is expected if the district keeps the current schools and programs.

Option A / Option B

The two scenarios. "A and B" means the same information applies to both.

School boundary

The area used to assign students to a neighborhood school based on where they live.

School communities joining

Students from two or more schools would come together. The proposal says which school building would close.

Programs joining

A program would come together at one school or move to another school.

DLI

Dual Language Immersion: learning in English and another language.

School size goal

More than 360 students for K-5 schools; more than 500 for K-8 or middle schools; more than 1,100 for high schools. These are planning goals, not ratings of school quality.

Space use goal

The district aims to use 70%-100% of a school's available room for students. A "No" can mean the school is below or above that range.

Title I

Federal money that supports schools serving students from low-income households. The guide shows the expected designation.

IEP

An Individualized Education Program: a written plan for a student's special education services and support.

Choice program

A program with a special focus, such as arts or science. It may serve families beyond a neighborhood school boundary.

Student groups

Groups can overlap. Do not add the percentages together.

**You may notice slight differences in student numbers and/or demographics in schools that don't experience change because a focus option school has changed and we assume that students return to their neighborhood school.*

HARRIET TUBMAN

School proposal | Options A and B

SCHOOL SNAPSHOT	DETAILS
Current program	Middle School neighborhood/language immersion
Expected enrollment with no changes	457 in 2027-28; 374 in 2031-32
District school size goal	More than 500 students
Students living within 1 mile	23.7%
Building notes	School space is described below.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

- Changing Vernon: Changing Vernon from a K-8 to a K-5 school requires a middle school location for 6th-8th grade students.
- Building a healthy student body: Harriet Tubman provides nearby classroom space, helping keep student numbers steady while ensuring students access a full range of middle school programs.
- Fewer split middle schools: The Irvington community would move to Beverly Cleary and to Beaumont to reduce split route to high schools in the region.

This is a proposal, not a final decision.

What is being proposed?

Harriet Tubman would remain open as a neighborhood middle school. Harriet Tubman would welcome 6th-8th grade students from Vernon as Vernon moves to a K-5 model. Middle grade students residing in the current Irvington school area would move to Beaumont Middle School.

What could students gain?

- Full middle school experience: Incoming Vernon students gain access to broader electives, athletics, and learning options at a comprehensive middle school.
- Stable school programs: Higher student numbers help support full-time middle school teachers and support staff.

What else was considered?

Option to stay: Policies would allow middle grade students currently living in the Irvington school area the option to stay at Harriet Tubman through 8th grade.

What about special education?

The 6–8 Intensive Skills Classroom currently located at Beverly Cleary will be relocated to Harriet Tubman Middle School and paired with the current Intensive Skills Classroom located at Tubman. To ensure a seamless transition, school and district leaders will conduct site walk-throughs to evaluate programmatic readiness, space, transportation, and ADA accessibility. Special education administrators will work closely with school principals to ensure every site is prepared to meet student IEP requirements.

